

# Abdullah Al Zahid

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**Nikki Kang**

Human Resources

Development Review Division, City of Toronto

**Re: Project Manager, Priority Development Review (Job ID 65977)**

Dear Nikki Kang,

I would like to apply for the Project Manager position with the Priority Development Review Service. I am an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning with the City, and reviewing development applications as they move through the City's process is a large part of my job.

I see that process from the commenting side. I review development applications and the studies filed with them against City standards and Official Plan policy, and recommend conditions where something is missing. From there I can see where an application tends to stall: a condition that is unclear, a study that answers a different question from the one being asked, or two divisions each waiting on the other. Coordinating the review so that technical experts keep responsibility for their advice while the file keeps moving is the part of this role I believe I would do well.

I coordinate with divisions, consultants, applicants and outside agencies whose priorities conflict, and I write the briefing notes and memos that carry issues and options to senior staff. I run assigned projects from scoping through to recommendations, planning the work and holding the schedule myself. At Metrolinx I set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions. Making a process faster and more predictable for the people who depend on it is the same instinct this role asks for.

I should be clear about where I fall short. I have not led a portfolio of development applications, led a project team, retained and managed consultants, or controlled project expenditures, and I have not briefed elected officials directly. My knowledge of Zoning By-law Amendment and Site Plan Control applications comes from reviewing them rather than steering them through approval. I am applying because the substance of the role is close to my daily work, and because the Qualified List covers both permanent and temporary positions.

Thank you for considering my application. I would welcome the chance to discuss the role.

Sincerely,

*Abdullah Al Zahid*

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